



### Pepper sprays

Priced approximately at Rs. 150, pepper spray cans are an affordable security measure for women

### MN2000

Scent Detection Technologies was recently honoured with the 2009 Explosives & Narcotics Trace Detection Product Line Strategy of the Year Award by consulting firm Frost & Sullivan

# Feel safe

**Pramoud Rao, Managing Director, Zicom Electronic Security Systems Ltd sheds light on measures we can take to be safer in society and also on interesting facts of the security and surveillance scene**

## Nash David

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**You ventured into security when there weren't any Indian brands. Did you foresee it to be a viable business?**

In 1995, electronic security as a category did not exist. With a large number of MNCs entering India and requiring security, we saw the opportunity, evaluated the risk and decided to build this category. We anticipated further growth with liberalisation, globalisation and the Y2K problem.

The business viability was a serious concern, since we were first generation entrepreneurs and category building often takes years. However, we took calculated risks and ventured into this unknown category. Fourteen years later, we're still in the process of building this category.

**What are the upcoming technologies in the field of security systems?**

Security being a closely related to IT, keeps evolving everyday. Currently, the flavour of the markets are remote video surveillance, video content analytics, explosive detectors, thermal imaging cameras, border security solutions, coastal security solutions, etc.

**Do you personally carry products with you, such as a taser? If so, which one?**

We do have a range of personal security products (PSPs). However, all of these are non-intrusive products. Tasers have not yet got the approval from the Home Ministry and cannot be used in India. I personally do not carry PSPs, although my wife carries a pepper spray.



**Pramoud Rao, Managing Director, Zicom Electronic Security Systems Ltd**

**Which personal security product would you recommend the average Indian? Any tips for women and children who are highly vulnerable these days?**

I would recommend people to use our home alarm systems while at home or even our video door phones. Women should carry Pepper Spray or personal security alarms, while children should carry an anti loss alarm kit.

**What are the trends you have witnessed in the average Indian's needs for home security?**

The video door phone is the most popular home security system currently being used. The latest model with memory is gaining acceptance and popularity. Home alarm systems come second. However, consumers are still

not investing as much as they should do.

**The demand for personal security systems would have definitely increased after the recent Mumbai attacks. Have you introduced any new products for public places, offices, halls, etc?**

The demand post the terror attack has gone up indeed. Nevertheless, the demand is more for law enforcement products. We have recently introduced the MN 2000, which is trace and scent detection used for all kinds and types of explosives. There are many products in the pipeline, which will be released depending on market demand.

**What is your opinion on the introduction of CCTV cameras and the 'Big**

**Brother' critique of the same?**

I personally feel CCTV cameras are a great boon especially for post investigation. Often, CCTV has proved to be a boon rather than a bane and whenever there is an incident the ROI is instant.

**While the three security systems types (personal, home and public) are meant to complement each other, if you had to pick one over the other for yourself, what would be the order you prefer and why?**

I would prefer a home security system since charity begins at home. Security also follows the same logic. At home, I have my personal belongings, my loved ones and valuables. Lastly, it is all the more important for me to protect what I value the most. 